

Noach 5784 (2)

In פרשת נח, after the extraordinary מסירות נפש of serving everyone in the תיבה, it was a devastating experience to come out to a world which had nothing. We know that נח was a צדיק, but for whatever reason (9:20) וַיִּקַּח נֹחַ אִשׁ הָאֲדָמָה וַיֵּשֶׁב בָּרָם, and became שיכור and הם came and saw what happened and told his two brothers. A famous pasuk (9:23): וַיִּקַּח שָׁם וְיָפֶת אֶת הַשְּׂמָלָה וַיְשִׁימוּ עַל שָׂרְבָם שְׁנֵיהֶם וַיַּלְכוּ אַחֲרָיָהּ וַיַּכְסּוּ אֹתָהּ. The מצוה brings a מדרש that says that שם and יפת got a שכר for doing this מצוה of אב כיבוד.

שם's שכר is after the מלחמת גוג ומגוג his offspring will be זוכה to קבורה when they die. What will שם get? שם will get clothing with which one can do the מצוה of ציצית. What's the difference between the two of them? The answer is, וַיִּקַּח שָׁם וְיָפֶת אֶת הַשְּׂמָלָה, that's a grammatically incorrect term. The Torah is specifically saying, "And he took," and it's talking about two people, so it should say וַיִּקְחוּ. The מדרש says שם took it with a מצוה לעבדוּת. He took it because he was trying to do this, and יפת tagged along, he schlepped along to do it, but he did it without any טעם, without any חיות, without any great enthusiasm. So one did a מצוה, and one did a מצוה טיטע. So guess what, the שכר is equally compensatory. It's מדה כנגד מדה. שם did it with a ברען, as a living מצוה, therefore he gets a living שכר. But יפת, you did a מצוה טיטע, you get a שכר that after you die, you're going to get buried, which is also a big זכות.

If you do a מצוה, do it with your whole heart. Do it the way that שם did it. That's the way to do a מצוה.